INCOMPLETE (read before citing): The network for this session reached only microsoft.com and anthropic.com. The Microsoft and Anthropic sources were fetched and checked against the raw page. Everything else was seen only through search-engine result summaries, marked "(search summary; page not fetched)" or "(search extract)". A gap-fill pass (2026-11-06) added: SEC, DOJ and FTC "AI washing" actions (Delphia and Global Predictions, Presto Automation, Nate/Saniger, Operation AI Comply), Gartner's "agent washing" estimate, Klarna's F-1 headcount figures and the scope of its reversal, Duolingo's measured backlash, and a further attempt to date the business use of "AI-native". STILL MISSING: Gartner, McKinsey, BCG, Deloitte and Accenture maturity models (BCG, McKinsey and Deloitte survey figures are in 04-enterprise.md); the Klarna F-1 risk-factor wording (only secondary reports of its headcount figures); SEC AI-washing actions after April 2025; filings and revenue for AI-native startups (Cursor, Midjourney, Gamma, Lovable); the first business or VC use of "AI-native" (still unresolved).

Track 1: What "AI-native" means

Last updated: 2026-11-06. Labels: EVIDENCE = measured/primary data; FORECAST = projection; OPINION = argument, vendor or consultancy view.

Verification note (added 2026-11-06): page fetches were blocked for most hosts this session, so findings marked search summary, search extract or snippet rest on search-engine extracts of the cited URL. Quotation marks inside findings mark wording as reported by that source; only quotes in this file's "Verbatim quotes" section (and in 13-quotes.md) were checked against a fetched page. Corrections from the verification pass are in verification.md.

Summary (5-8 bullets, the things that matter most)

- **No one agrees on what "AI-native" means, and none of the sources I could reach defines it by shared context.** Software and VC writing defines it by **origin** (built around AI from day one) or by **dependency** (the product would not work without models). Telecom defines it by **architecture** (AI designed into every layer instead of added on top). Consultancy and vendor models define it by **breadth of deployment plus self-reported ROI**. Ericsson's own white paper opens by saying the term has no clear definition.
- **Telecom is the earliest documented formal use I found.** Nokia Bell Labs wrote "AI-native air interface" in a paper first posted to arXiv in December 2020 (2012.08285); the Bell Labs page dates it May 2021. Ericsson followed with a 2023 white paper and a maturity matrix. I could not establish who first used the term in software or VC writing. I found no evidence that anyone "coined" it in the business sense.
- **The best primary support for the user's shared-context idea comes from Anthropic, a model vendor.** Its September 2025 Economic Index (1M API transcripts) says complex enterprise deployment "might be constrained more by access to information than on underlying model capabilities". It adds that firms may need to "centralize information". This is inferred from input-length patterns, not measured directly, and it comes from a party with a commercial interest.
- **Microsoft's 2026 Work Trend Index moves toward the user's framing.** It uses the terms "Owned Intelligence" (institutional know-how that compounds) and "Learning System". It says Frontier Firms "encode" agent signals "into shared routines". But its maturity classification is based on self-reported culture, manager support and governance, not on any shared context store.

- **The same 2026 report weakens the "people resist" part of the thesis.** Its framing: "people are ready. The systems around them are not." In the survey, 10% of AI users are skilled workers blocked by their organisation, against 5% where the organisation is ready and the people are not. Only 13% say they are rewarded for reinventing work with AI (n=20,000, self-report).
- **Regulators police false AI capability claims, not the label.** The SEC (Delphia and Global Predictions, March 2024, $400,000; Presto Automation, January 2025), DOJ and SEC (Nate, April 2025, $40M+ raised on an "AI" app run by Philippine contract workers) and the FTC (Operation AI Comply, five companies, September 2024) all acted where claimed AI was absent or was humans or a third party. Gartner separately estimates only about 130 of thousands of "agentic" vendors are genuine (no method published).
- **Named "AI-first" rebuilds were mostly headcount policies and customer-service automation, not shared-context platforms.** The cases are Klarna, Duolingo, Shopify, Salesforce and IBM. Recorded failures were about quality (Klarna's CEO said the AI produced "lower quality" service), brand backlash (Duolingo) and viral exaggeration (IBM "8,000", Salesforce "4,000").
- **Even inside a highly AI-native organisation, full delegation stays small.** Anthropic's study of its own engineers (n=132 survey, 53 interviews, 200k transcripts): Claude was used in 59% of work, but most engineers can "fully delegate" only 0-20%. The costs reported were less mentorship and less collaboration. This undercuts the claim that "the tech is the easy part": supervising the agent remains the binding constraint.
- **The user's "legacy = humans only" category is close to empty in the survey data.** The 2025 Work Trend Index survey screened knowledge workers across 31 countries, and the 2026 edition sampled only AI users. Every maturity model I saw starts at "some AI use", so a "humans only" baseline matches no published framework. The spectrum idea does match them, but they measure position on it by deployment breadth or self-reported readiness, not by context architecture.

Key findings

Where the term comes from (telecom first, as far as I could establish)

- **[EVIDENCE]** Nokia Bell Labs paper "Toward a 6G AI-Native Air Interface". The arXiv version (2012.08285) dates from December 2020 (inferred from the arXiv ID). It proposes an air interface "partially designed by AI" and uses the phrase "AI-Native Air Interface (AI-AI)". The Bell Labs page dates it May 2021. (Search summary; pages not fetched: arXiv and nokia.com blocked.) https://arxiv.org/pdf/2012.08285 and https://www.nokia.com/bell-labs/publications-and-media/publications/towards-a-6g-ai-native-air-interface/
- **[OPINION]** Ericsson white paper "Defining AI native: A key enabler for advanced intelligent telecom networks", probably March 2023 (date unconfirmed). Per search snippets, it says the AI native concept "still does not have a clear definition". It names an "AI-centric architecture" as the goal and offers an "AI native Maturity Level Matrix" for operators. (Search summary; page not fetched.) https://www.ericsson.com/en/reports-and-papers/white-papers/ai-native
- **[OPINION]** Ericsson Technology Review, 2023, "Approaching AI-native radio-access networks". It proposes a stepwise path to a more AI-native RAN. (Search summary; not fetched.) https://www.ericsson.com/4928b8/assets/local/reports-papers/ericsson-technology-review/docs/2023/approaching-ai-native-radio-access-networks.pdf
- **[OPINION]** IEEE ComSoc tech blog, 15 Jan 2026. It contrasts "AI Native" in 6G (IMT-2030) with "AI overlay/add-on" in 5G and reports that ITU-R WP 5D treats AI as foundational to IMT-2030.

(Search summary; not fetched.) https://techblog.comsoc.org/2026/01/15/comparing-ai-native-mode-in-6g-imt-2030-vs-ai-overlay-add-on-status-in-5g-imt-2020/

- **[EVIDENCE, weak]** NVIDIA and T-Mobile: AI-RAN Innovation Center (2024), later extended to "AI-native 6G" research. At MWC 2026, NVIDIA announced commitments from more than a dozen telecom and technology firms to build 6G on "AI-native" platforms. One trade report says the AI-RAN Alliance has 75+ members but fewer than 10 operators. (Search summary; not fetched.) https://www.telecomtv.com/content/telcos-and-ai-channel/nvidia-eyes-6g-with-ai-native-telco-stack-52624/ ; https://www.crnasia.com/news/2026/networking/nvidia-bets-big-on-ai-native-networks-at-mwc-2026
- **[EVIDENCE, weak]** I found no 3GPP primary document defining "AI-native". Secondary sources say Release 20 includes 6G study items and AI/ML air-interface work (e.g. two-sided models for CSI compression), with the first 6G specifications expected in Release 21. (Search summary; not fetched.) https://www.qualcomm.com/news/onq/2025/06/3gpp-release-20-completing-5g-advanced-evolution-preparing-for-global-6g-standardization
- **What the telecom meaning is.** "Native" means AI is designed into the system from the start (models replace hand-designed signal-processing blocks, with lifecycle management built in), as opposed to AI bolted onto a finished design. It is a statement about **architecture**, not about how people work. The business usage borrowed the word, and probably the "cloud-native" analogy, but not the precise meaning. This analogy point is my inference; I did not find a source documenting the borrowing.

Software, VC and vendor definitions

- **[OPINION]** VC and glossary definitions mostly use a dependency test: would the product or business work without its models? An "AI-native company's core product, cost structure, or competitive moat depends fundamentally on AI capability". (Search summary; not fetched.) https://vcbeast.com/venture-capital-glossary/ai-native-company
- **[OPINION]** Intel Capital, investor essay (date not confirmed). It treats AI-native as a subset of AI companies and extends the idea beyond software to manufacturing, services and healthcare. (Search summary; not fetched.) https://www.intelcapital.com/an-investor-search-for-an-ai-native-company/
- **[OPINION]** TechCrunch, 2 May 2024, "Your AI-native startup ain't the same as a typical SaaS company". This was the earliest dated mainstream-tech use I saw in search results. That is not evidence of first use. (Search summary; not fetched.) https://techcrunch.com/2024/05/02/your-ai-native-startup-aint-the-same-as-a-typical-saas-company/amp
- **[OPINION]** CRV (VC firm) defines AI-native by architecture: the product was built on AI from the ground up, and without the intelligence layer the company would not exist in any meaningful form (paraphrase). Undated. https://www.crv.com/content/what-is-ai-native (search extract)
- **[EVIDENCE, weak]** Dating the VC usage (gap-fill pass): the earliest dated VC-firm use found was Nava Ventures, which launched in 2023 with a stated focus on "AI-native enterprise companies" (per a VC directory). A targeted search for 2017 to 2018 business uses returned nothing. Who first used "AI-native" in business remains unresolved; the telecom use (Nokia Bell Labs, December 2020) is still the earliest documented use I found. https://vcbeast.com/vc-firms/nava-ventures (search extract)
- **[OPINION]** I could not reach a16z, Sequoia or Bessemer primary pages. Secondary summaries attribute an "AI-native vs retrofit" framing to a16z, but I could not check the wording. Treat it as unverified.

- **[OPINION]** An industry explainer separates "AI-native" (built around AI from the ground up) from "AI-first" (an incumbent that tears down and rebuilds around AI). Another notes the term "remains ill-defined and is often used as marketing". (Search summary; not fetched.) https://letsdatascience.com/news/ai-community-wrestles-with-defining-ai-native-3ce3828c
- **[OPINION]** Foundation Capital (Jaya Gupta, Ashu Garg), Dec 2025, "AI's trillion-dollar opportunity: Context graphs". Argument: value shifts from systems of record (Salesforce, Workday, SAP) to "systems of agents". A "context graph" that records decision traces (why decisions were made, not only what happened) becomes the new system of record. **This is the closest published framework to the user's "one stored shared context, read and written by humans and agents".** It is a VC thesis, not a standard, and I read it only through secondary summaries. (Not fetched; the summary was reached via a mirror.) https://foundationcapital.com/context-graphs-ais-trillion-dollar-opportunity/

Maturity models compared

Model	Unit measured	Stages	Basis	What decides your stage
Microsoft WTI 2025 "Frontier Firm"	Organisation (via leader self-report)	3 phases: AI as assistant; agents as digital colleagues; humans set direction, agents run processes	Survey n=31,000 in 31 countries, Feb-Mar 2025; 844 leaders classed Frontier	Leader says: org-wide AI deployment, "a leader" in AI investment, measuring ROI, some ROI seen, using agents
Microsoft WTI 2026	Individual AI user vs organisational readiness	5 groups: Frontier 19%, emergent (about half), blocked agency 10%, unclaimed capacity 5%, stalled 16%	Survey n=20,000 AI users in 10 markets, Feb-Apr 2026, plus M365 telemetry	Self-reported composites (usage sophistication, governance, manager support, AI culture)
MIT CISR Enterprise AI Maturity	Enterprise	4 stages, from "Experiment and Prepare" up to "AI future-ready"	Survey n=721 (2022) plus 9 interviews (2024)	Capability build-out; financial performance below industry average in stages 1-2, above it in stages 3-4
Ericsson AI native maturity matrix	Telecom network artifact	Levels (count not verified)	Engineering framework	How deeply AI is built into the network function

- **[EVIDENCE, weak: vendor survey, self-report]** Microsoft WTI 2025. Frontier Firms are "Structured around on-demand intelligence and powered by 'hybrid' teams of humans + agents". 24% of leaders report org-wide AI deployment; 12% are still in pilots. Frontier Firm leaders were more likely to say their company is thriving (71%, against 39% of workers globally). Run by Edelman Data x Intelligence, 6 Feb to 24 Mar 2025, 1,000 per market. Microsoft, 23 Apr 2025. https://www.microsoft.com/en-us/worklab/work-trend-index/2025-the-year-the-frontier-firm-is-born
    - Weakness: Frontier status is defined by leaders saying their firm is "a leader" in AI investment and has seen ROI, so the label partly measures confidence. The "thriving" comparison sets Frontier leaders against workers globally, which is not like-for-like.
- **[EVIDENCE, weak: vendor survey, self-report]** Microsoft WTI 2026, "Agents, human agency, and the opportunity for every organization", 5 May 2026. Survey n=20,000 AI users (people who never use AI were screened out) in 10 markets, run 18 Feb to 20 Apr 2026. Organisational factors (culture, manager support, talent practices) account for 67% of modelled "AI impact" against 32% for individual factors. The model is a random-forest permutation importance; Microsoft notes it is associational, not causal. Active agents in Microsoft 365 grew 15x year on year. https://www.microsoft.com/en-us/worklab/work-trend-index/agents-human-agency-and-the-opportunity-for-every-organization

- **[EVIDENCE, weak: vendor survey]** WTI 2026 also reports how rarely agent work is documented, even among the most advanced users. Agent workflows, human handoffs and quality standards are "documented and repeatable" at organisation level for 25% of Frontier Professionals against 14% of others (team level: 26% against 19%). This bears directly on the user's "nobody can describe the real workflow" point. Same URL.
- **[EVIDENCE, moderate: academic survey, pre-genAI]** MIT CISR (Weill, Woerner, Sebastian), Dec 2024: four stages. About 28% of firms were in stage 1 and 31% in stage 3. Firms in stages 1-2 had below-industry-average financial performance; stages 3-4 were above it. The survey dates from 2022, so it mostly reflects analytical AI, not generative AI or agents. The relationship is cross-sectional (correlational). (Search summary; cisr.mit.edu blocked.) https://cisr.mit.edu/sites/default/files/2024-12/EnterpriseAIMaturityModel_CISRpressrelease_121924_0.pdf

Where the models disagree:

1. **Unit of analysis.** Ericsson rates a network artifact. CISR rates the enterprise. WTI 2025 rates the firm through its leaders. WTI 2026 rates the individual inside an organisational context.
2. **What counts as progress.** Telecom: how deeply AI is built into the architecture. CISR: capabilities plus financial outcomes. Microsoft: deployment breadth, agent use and self-reported ROI.
3. **Where the bottleneck sits.** WTI 2026 puts it in the organisation (incentives, managers). The Anthropic Economic Index puts it in information access ("context"). The Klarna case points to output quality.
4. **None of them** uses "shared stored context that humans and agents both read and write" as the defining test. Microsoft 2026 comes nearest, with "Owned Intelligence" and "shared routines".

Primary evidence that context is the constraint (closest support for the user's definition)

- **[EVIDENCE, moderate: vendor data, large n, inferential]** Anthropic Economic Index, 15 Sep 2025. Data: 1M first-party API transcripts from Aug 2025, which Anthropic says is about half of first-party API use. 77% of API transcripts show automation patterns, against 12% augmentation. Longer inputs go with complex tasks (input-output elasticity 0.38). From this, the authors infer that dispersed, non-centralised context is a barrier to enterprise deployment. They also note that software works partly because code repositories already centralise context. https://www.anthropic.com/research/anthropic-economic-index-september-2025-report
    - Why it matters for the user: **Software development is the one domain that already has a single shared store humans and agents both read and write (the code repository).** That is also where agent adoption is furthest along. This supports the user's definition as a description of preconditions. It is Anthropic's inference, not a controlled test.

Named companies that rebuilt around AI

Klarna

- **[EVIDENCE, weak: company claim]** Feb 2024: Klarna said its AI assistant did the work of 700 full-time customer service agents and handled 75% of chats. (Search summary; not fetched.) https://www.emarketer.com/content/klarna-backtracks-ai-customer-service-plans

- **[EVIDENCE, weak: press reports of company figures]** Headcount fell from about 5,000 to 3,800 in 2024, mostly by attrition. A spokesperson said it would likely fall toward about 2,000. Fortune, 28 Aug 2024. (Search summary; not fetched.) https://fortune.com/europe/2024/08/28/klarna-1800-employees-ai-replace-ipo
- **[EVIDENCE, weak: company financials via press]** Revenue per employee is approaching $1M, up from $575k a year earlier. TechCrunch, 19 May 2025. (Search summary; not fetched.) https://techcrunch.com/2025/05/19/klarnas-revenue-per-employee-soars-to-nearly-1m-thanks-to-ai-efficiency-push/
- **[EVIDENCE: CEO statement via press]** What broke: in May 2025, CEO Sebastian Siemiatkowski told Bloomberg that cost had been "a too predominant evaluation factor" and that the result was "lower quality". Klarna began hiring humans so customers can always reach a person. Klarna says this is freelance hiring for its outsourcing arm and that headcount still falls through attrition, so the scope of the "reversal" is disputed. (Search summary; not fetched.) https://www.entrepreneur.com/business-news/klarna-ceo-reverses-course-by-hiring-more-humans-not-ai/491396 ; https://www.computing.co.uk/news/2025/ai/meat-back-on-the-menu-as-klarna-rows-back-on-ai
- **[EVIDENCE, weak: company claim via press]** The February 2024 claim in detail: the assistant handled 2.3 million chats in its first month, two-thirds of customer service chats, the equivalent work of 700 full-time agents, and cut average resolution time from 11 minutes to 2. Klarna had frozen non-engineering hiring in December 2023. https://www.euronews.com/2024/02/28/klarnas-ai-bot-is-doing-the-work-of-700-employees-what-will-happen-to-their-jobs ; https://www.itpro.com/technology/artificial-intelligence/klarna-has-stopped-hiring-amid-its-relentless-ai-efficiency-drive (search extract)
- **[EVIDENCE: filing, via secondary reports]** Klarna's F-1 (filed March 2025) reportedly gives full-time employees of 5,527 at end-2022 and 3,422 at end-2024 (down about 38%), and attributes the fall to increased use of AI and natural attrition. I saw the filing URL but not the relevant page or the risk-factor wording. The CEO separately told CNBC that AI was only one factor. F-1: https://www.sec.gov/Archives/edgar/data/2003292/000162828025012824/klarnagroupplcf-1.htm ; report of the figures: https://getcoai.com/news/swedens-klarna-attributes-reduced-headcount-to-ai-chatbot-efficiencies (search extract)
- **Scope of the reversal (gap-fill pass).** The May 2025 move was to add human agents (remote and freelance) so customers can always reach a person, with AI still handling routine contacts. A later CMSWire headline reports the CEO saying Klarna is giving AI more customer-service work, not less; I saw only the headline. So the reversal is a hybrid model with a human fallback, not an abandonment of AI. https://www.cmswire.com/contact-center/klarna-ceo-were-giving-ai-more-customer-service-work-not-less/ (search extract)

Duolingo

- **[EVIDENCE: primary memo via press]** On 28 Apr 2025, CEO Luis von Ahn posted the "AI-first" memo on LinkedIn. It said Duolingo would "gradually stop using contractors to do work that AI can handle". After backlash, a late-May follow-up said hiring would continue and AI would not replace employees. In an Aug 2025 NYT interview he said "This was on me. I did not give enough context" and that Duolingo has never laid off full-time employees. (Search summary; not fetched.) https://fortune.com/2025/08/18/duolingo-ceo-admits-controversial-ai-memo-did-not-give-enough-context-insists-company-never-laid-off-full-time-employees ; https://www.entrepreneur.com/business-news/duolingo-ceo-clarifies-ai-stance-after-backlash-read-memo/492141
- What changed: contractor content work moved to AI. What broke: brand and user trust (complaints about content quality), not operations.

- **[EVIDENCE, weak: sell-side analyst and CEO statements via press]** Measured cost of the backlash (gap-fill pass): Morgan Stanley linked the memo to about a 10% decline in US daily active users since April 2025, with international trends steady. Von Ahn said it may have hurt DAU in the quarter to June and that the effect was almost entirely in the United States and Canada (paraphrase). Total DAU still grew: about 47.7 million in Q2 2025 (+40% YoY), and a reported 56.5 million in Q1 2026 (+21% YoY), so growth slowed but did not reverse. The company toned down its "edgy" social posting rather than pausing it. https://www.itiger.com/news/2549526150 ; https://www.aol.com/duolingos-ceo-says-learned-hard-062205679.html (search extract). Slowing growth has other possible causes; the attribution to the memo is the analyst's and the CEO's.

Shopify

- **[EVIDENCE: primary memo via press]** Tobi Lütke's memo was written in March 2025 and posted on X on 7 Apr 2025. Two rules: AI use is a "baseline expectation", and AI-usage questions go into performance reviews. Before asking for headcount, teams must demonstrate why they cannot get what they want done using AI. (Search summary; not fetched. Not quoted because I could not see the raw memo.) https://betakit.com/shopify-ceo-tobi-lutke-tells-employees-to-prove-ai-cant-do-the-job-before-asking-for-resources/
- Note: this is a management policy, not a rebuilt architecture. It does not mention shared context.

Salesforce

- **[EVIDENCE: CEO statement via press]** On The Logan Bartlett Show (aired around 29 Aug 2025), Marc Benioff said support headcount went from about 9,000 to about 5,000 because of Agentforce. He called it a "rebalance". A spokesperson said fewer support cases removed the need to backfill and that staff were redeployed to sales and customer success. No timeframe was given. (Search summary; not fetched.) https://fortune.com/2025/09/02/salesforce-ceo-billionaire-marc-benioff-ai-agents-jobs-layoffs-customer-service-sales/ ; https://www.salesforceben.com/ai-agents-drive-4000-job-cuts-in-salesforce-support-division/

IBM

- **[EVIDENCE: CEO statement via press]** In May 2025, Arvind Krishna told the WSJ that AI (the AskHR agent) replaced "a couple of hundred" HR roles. He said total headcount rose ("we've added more roles than we've removed"). Reports say AskHR automates 94% of routine HR tasks, a share of tasks, not of staff. (Search summary; not fetched.) https://www.entrepreneur.com/business-news/ibm-ceo-ai-replaced-hundreds-of-human-resources-staff/491341

Moderna

- **[EVIDENCE: proxy filing via search]** Tracey Franklin moved from Chief HR Officer to Chief People and Digital Technology Officer in November 2024, merging HR and IT. A WSJ report (date unconfirmed) says she is redesigning teams around which work people do and which is automated, partly using the OpenAI partnership. The same report says Moderna cut about 10% of digital technology jobs (about 50 people) and that the former CIO left. (Search summary; not fetched.) https://www.sec.gov/Archives/edgar/data/1682852/000130817926000081/mrna-courtesy-pdf.pdf ; https://investors.modernatx.com/tracey-franklin
- Why it matters: this is the clearest case of org design changing, not just headcount. Merging people and technology functions treats agents and humans as one workforce.

Intercom / Fin

- **[EVIDENCE, weak: third-party pricing guides; ARR unverified]** Fin is priced at $0.99 per resolution (only when it resolves without a human handoff), on top of seats. Secondary sources put Fin ARR near or above $100M by 2026 and Intercom total ARR near $400M. I found no primary Intercom filing or statement. (Search summary; not fetched.) https://www.eesel.ai/blog/fin-ai-pricing
- What changed: the pricing model moved from per-seat to per-outcome. That is a real business-model rebuild, and the user could use it as an example.

Anthropic (a model vendor studying itself)

- **[EVIDENCE, moderate: self-study, n=132 survey, 53 interviews, 200k Claude Code transcripts]** Published 2 Dec 2025. Engineers self-report using Claude in 59% of their work (28% a year earlier) and a +50% productivity gain (+20% a year earlier). Merged pull requests per engineer per day rose 67%. 27% of Claude-assisted work "wouldn't have been done otherwise". More than half can "fully delegate" only 0-20%. What broke: fewer questions to senior staff (less mentorship), less collaboration, worries about skill atrophy. https://www.anthropic.com/research/how-ai-is-transforming-work-at-anthropic

"AI-native" as marketing

- **[OPINION]** Commentators say the term is "often used as marketing rather than to describe a coherent architectural shift". (Search summary; not fetched.) https://letsdatascience.com/news/ai-community-wrestles-with-defining-ai-native-3ce3828c
- **[OPINION]** Microsoft WTI 2025 itself says it "interviewed 12 AI-native startups" without defining the term. The label is used as self-evident. https://www.microsoft.com/en-us/worklab/work-trend-index/2025-the-year-the-frontier-firm-is-born
- **[EVIDENCE, weak]** The ComSoc and trade-press telecom pieces show "AI-native" moving from a defined engineering term (Nokia, Ericsson) to a vendor coalition banner (NVIDIA MWC 2026) within about five years.

"AI washing" enforcement and "agent washing" (gap-fill pass)

Regulators have now defined, case by case, what a false AI claim looks like. In every case so far the gap was between "our AI does X" and humans or third parties doing X. That is the enforceable edge of "AI-native as marketing".

- **[EVIDENCE: regulatory action]** SEC, 18 March 2024 (press release 2024-36): settled charges against two investment advisers, Delphia (USA) and Global Predictions, for false and misleading statements about their use of AI. Penalties $225,000 and $175,000 ($400,000 total), without admitting or denying. The SEC found Delphia claimed AI and machine-learning capabilities from 2019 to 2023 that it did not have; Global Predictions described itself as the first regulated AI financial adviser (paraphrase of reported wording). https://www.sec.gov/newsroom/press-releases/2024-36 (search extract)
- **[EVIDENCE: regulatory action]** SEC, 14 January 2025: settled charges against Presto Automation, reported as the first AI-washing action against a public company. The SEC said Presto's filings presented its Presto Voice drive-through ordering product as in-house technology that removed human order-taking, while the deployed technology was owned and operated by a third party, and the large majority of orders (reported as over 70%) needed human intervention. Penalty amount not seen. https://www.dandodiary.com/2025/01/articles/artificial-intelligence/sec-files-ai-washing-enforcement-action-against-restaurant-technology-

company/ ; https://ropesgray.com/en/insights/alerts/2025/01/ai-washing-enforcement-in-the-final-days-of-the-gensler-administration (search extract; the SEC primary URL did not surface)

- **[EVIDENCE: criminal indictment and SEC complaint; allegations, not findings]** DOJ (SDNY) and SEC, 9 April 2025: Albert Saniger, former CEO of the shopping app Nate, charged with securities and wire fraud. Prosecutors allege he raised over $40 million from investors by claiming purchases were automated by AI, while hundreds of contract workers in a Philippine call centre completed them by hand; the DOJ says the real automation rate was effectively 0%. Commentators noted these were the first AI-washing actions under the new administration, so enforcement continued after the change of SEC leadership. https://www.justice.gov/usao-sdny/pr/tech-ceo-charged-artificial-intelligence-investment-fraud-scheme ; https://www.debevoise.com/insights/publications/2025/04/the-sec-and-doj-signal-continued-focus-on-ai-wash (search extract)
- **[EVIDENCE: regulatory action]** FTC "Operation AI Comply", 25 September 2024: actions against five companies (DoNotPay, Ascend Ecom, Ecommerce Empire Builders, Rytr, FBA Machine). DoNotPay, the self-described "robot lawyer", had not tested whether its outputs matched a lawyer's; it agreed to pay $193,000 (as reported). Rytr was barred from selling AI-generated consumer-review services. Three were income schemes using "AI-powered" claims. https://www.ftc.gov/news-events/news/press-releases/2024/09/ftc-announces-crackdown-deceptive-ai-claims-schemes (search extract)
- **[OPINION: analyst estimate]** Gartner, 25 June 2025: "agent washing" (rebranding assistants, RPA and chatbots as agentic) is widespread; only about 130 of the thousands of vendors claiming agentic AI are real. No method published. Full treatment in 04-enterprise.md. https://www.gartner.com/en/newsroom/press-releases/2025-06-25-gartner-predicts-over-40-percent-of-agentic-ai-projects-will-be-canceled-by-end-of-2027
- Not found: SEC AI-washing actions after April 2025. One 2026 legal blog discusses AI-washing litigation in 2026 but I did not see specific new cases. https://blog.promise.legal/ai-washing-litigation-2026-public-company-gcs/ (search extract)
- Why it matters for the user: no enforcement action has tested the term "AI-native" itself. The actions target specific false capability claims (automation rates, in-house technology, AI that did not exist). A firm calling itself "AI-native" is legally exposed only if it states facts about its AI that are untrue. The Presto and Nate cases are also a warning about the "human behind the agent" pattern that agent platforms with human escalation must disclose accurately.

Viral statistics traced (where relevant)

- **Klarna "AI does the work of 700 agents".** The source is Klarna's own Feb 2024 announcement. It is an unaudited company claim based on chat volume. The CEO's May 2025 statements about lower quality complicate it. Treat it as a company claim, not a measured result. https://www.emarketer.com/content/klarna-backtracks-ai-customer-service-plans. The F-1 figures (5,527 FTEs end-2022 to 3,422 end-2024, reportedly attributed to AI and attrition) are the more solid number, but they cover the whole company and do not isolate AI. https://www.sec.gov/Archives/edgar/data/2003292/000162828025012824/klarnagroupplcf-1.htm
- **"Klarna reversed its AI strategy".** Overstated. It added a human fallback for customers and kept AI on routine contacts. https://www.cmswire.com/contact-center/klarna-ceo-were-giving-ai-more-customer-service-work-not-less/ (headline only)
- **"Duolingo lost users over its AI-first memo".** Partly true: Morgan Stanley linked it to about a 10% fall in US daily users, but total DAU still grew about 40% YoY in Q2 2025. https://www.itiger.com/news/2549526150

- **"IBM fired 8,000 people and replaced them with AI".** This blends separate events. The CEO said "a couple of hundred" HR roles were replaced, and total headcount rose. The 8,000 figure traces to layoff coverage and viral posts, not to IBM. The "94%" refers to routine HR tasks automated, not jobs. https://www.entrepreneur.com/business-news/ibm-ceo-ai-replaced-hundreds-of-human-resources-staff/491341
- **"Salesforce cut 4,000 jobs because of AI".** The source is a Benioff podcast remark. He described it as a "rebalance" with no backfill and redeployment, over an unstated period. "Layoffs" is the press framing. https://fortune.com/2025/09/02/salesforce-ceo-billionaire-marc-benioff-ai-agents-jobs-layoffs-customer-service-sales/
- **Shopify "prove AI can't do the job before hiring".** This paraphrase is sharper than the memo. Per coverage, the memo asks teams to demonstrate why they cannot get what they want done using AI. https://betakit.com/shopify-ceo-tobi-lutke-tells-employees-to-prove-ai-cant-do-the-job-before-asking-for-resources/
- **Duolingo "replacing staff with AI".** The memo covered contractors, and the CEO says no full-time staff were laid off. https://fortune.com/2025/08/18/duolingo-ceo-admits-controversial-ai-memo-did-not-give-enough-context-insists-company-never-laid-off-full-time-employees
- **Microsoft "Frontier Firm leaders: 71% thriving".** The comparison group is workers globally, not non-Frontier leaders. The Frontier group is 844 self-classified leaders. https://www.microsoft.com/en-us/worklab/work-trend-index/2025-the-year-the-frontier-firm-is-born

Strongest counter-evidence (against the thesis and against the mainstream reading of this track)

1. **"The tech is the easy part" is contradicted by the most AI-ready organisation available to study.** Anthropic has a centralised codebase, staff who are fully bought in, and unlimited model access. Even so, most engineers can fully delegate only 0-20% of their work, and supervision stays essential. The limit there is model reliability, not readiness. https://www.anthropic.com/research/how-ai-is-transforming-work-at-anthropic
2. **Klarna's partial reversal was about output quality, not resistance or missing context.** The CEO blamed over-weighting cost, not staff readiness. https://www.entrepreneur.com/business-news/klarna-ceo-reverses-course-by-hiring-more-humans-not-ai/491396
3. **"People resist" gets weak support in the largest 2026 survey.** Microsoft finds more skilled workers blocked by their organisation (10%) than organisations held back by their people (5%). 45% say it feels safer to stick to current goals than to redesign work, and only 13% are rewarded for reinvention. The resistance is structural (incentives, metrics), not personal. Caveat: vendor survey, self-report, AI users only. https://www.microsoft.com/en-us/worklab/work-trend-index/agents-human-agency-and-the-opportunity-for-every-organization
4. **Against the user's definition: the firms most often called AI-first changed policy and headcount, not shared context.** If "AI-native" requires one shared read/write context, then Klarna, Shopify, Duolingo and Salesforce, as reported, would not qualify. The user should either accept that or say that the common usage is something else.
5. **Against the mainstream "AI-native = built from scratch" reading: the evidence on startups is thin.** I could not verify any revenue-per-employee figure for Cursor, Midjourney, Gamma or Lovable this session. Many of those figures circulate from founder tweets and press, not filings.
6. **For the thesis (to stay honest): two independent sources point to the organisation as the bottleneck.** Anthropic (context access) and Microsoft 2026 (incentives and

managers) both say so, with different data. The "shared context" part of the thesis has its best support in the Anthropic data.

Testing the user's working definitions

User's claim	What I found	Verdict
AI-native = humans and agents work from one stored, shared business context	No accessible framework defines it this way. Telecom: AI in the architecture. VC: AI dependency or origin. Consultancies and vendors: deployment breadth plus ROI. Nearest matches: Foundation Capital "context graphs" (VC opinion), Microsoft 2026 "Owned Intelligence" and "shared routines" (vendor), Anthropic's "centralize information" (vendor research).	**Idiosyncratic but defensible.** It is a precondition definition (what must be true for agents to do non-trivial work), not the market definition. Say so explicitly.
One platform both read from and write to	Software repos meet this test and are where agent adoption leads (Anthropic AEI). No maturity model requires a single platform. Microsoft 2026 instead stresses identity, permissions and governance across agents.	**Partly supported** by the software analogy. "One platform" sounds vendor-shaped (it matches Actualisation's own product), and readers may discount it for that reason. "Shared context" stands up better without "one platform".
Legacy = humans only, no AI in the workflow	Survey data suggests this group is close to empty among knowledge workers (WTI 2025 surveyed 31 countries; the 2026 edition sampled AI users only). Every maturity model starts at "some AI".	**Too strict to be useful.** A more useful "legacy" marker might be "AI use is individual and unrecorded: nothing agents or people learn goes back into a shared store".
Spectrum; fully AI-native is rare	Matches Microsoft (3 phases, 5 groups, 19% Frontier users), CISR (4 stages) and Ericsson (maturity matrix).	**Matches the literature.** But each model puts firms on the spectrum by a different axis.

Open questions

These are unverified leads; check each before using it.

- **SEC, DOJ and FTC "AI washing" actions:** now sourced (see the enforcement section). Still open: the Presto penalty and SEC order URL; the outcome of the Saniger case; any SEC or FTC AI-washing actions after April 2025; whether the FTC's later actions (2025-26) continued Operation AI Comply.
- **Gartner "agent washing":** sourced (press release URL above), but the method behind "about 130" is unpublished.
- **Klarna F-1 risk factors:** the headcount figures are reported second-hand; the wording on AI and customer-service quality risk still needs a direct read of the filing.
- **Maturity models not reached:** Gartner AI Maturity Model (5 levels), McKinsey State of AI 2025 ("high performers"), BCG "The Widening AI Value Gap" (Sept 2025, "future-built" share), Deloitte State of GenAI in the Enterprise, Accenture reinvention reports. Each needs the original methodology.
- **Academic definitions:** Iansiti & Lakhani, Competing in the Age of AI (2020), "AI factory" operating model with an integrated data platform. This is possibly the strongest academic match to the "shared context" definition. Also Hassan et al. on "AI-native software engineering" (arXiv). Not verified.
- **Earliest business use of "AI-native"** and its relation to Google's "AI-first" (2016) and CNCF's "cloud-native". Not verified.
- **Small-headcount, high-revenue startups** (Cursor/Anysphere, Midjourney, Gamma, Lovable): ARR and headcount from primary statements.
- **Earliest business use of "AI-native":** a gap-fill search for 2017-2018 uses found nothing; the earliest dated VC-firm use found is 2023 (Nava Ventures). Try Google Books Ngram or news archives, which this environment could not reach.

What's genuinely uncertain

- Whether shared context causes better agent outcomes or only travels with them. The Anthropic evidence is an inference from input lengths; I found no controlled comparison.
- Whether Microsoft's "organisational factors explain 2x" survives outside self-report. Both the predictors and the outcome are survey perceptions from the same respondents (common-method bias).
- Whether CISR's stage-to-performance link holds for generative and agentic AI. Its survey is from 2022.
- How much of the Klarna, Salesforce and IBM headcount change is due to AI rather than attrition, post-2021 over-hiring and cost cutting. The companies have reasons to credit AI.
- Who first used "AI-native" in business. I could not settle it.

Numbers for the facts file

Figure	What it measures	Source	URL	Date	Reliability note
77% vs 12%	Share of Anthropic first-party API transcripts showing automation vs augmentation patterns	Anthropic Economic Index	https://www.anthropic.com/research/anthropic-economic-index-september-2025-report	2025-09-15	Vendor data, 1M transcripts (Aug 2025), classifier-based. Fetched + grep-verified
0.38	Elasticity of output to input token length (basis for the "context bottleneck" inference)	Anthropic Economic Index	same	2025-09-15	Inferential; author interpretation. Fetched
59% (from 28%)	Share of their work Anthropic engineers use Claude for, self-reported	Anthropic	https://www.anthropic.com/research/how-ai-is-transforming-work-at-anthropic	2025-12-02	Self-report, n=132. Fetched + grep-verified
0-20%	Share of work most Anthropic engineers say they can "fully delegate"	Anthropic	same	2025-12-02	Self-report. Fetched + grep-verified
27%	Claude-assisted work that "wouldn't have been done otherwise"	Anthropic	same	2025-12-02	Self-estimate. Fetched + grep-verified
844 of 31,000	Leaders classed as Frontier Firm, of total respondents	Microsoft WTI 2025	https://www.microsoft.com/en-us/worklab/work-trend-index/2025-the-year-the-frontier-firm-is-born	2025-04-23	Vendor survey (Edelman); self-classification. Fetched
24% / 12%	Leaders reporting org-wide AI deployment / still in pilot	Microsoft WTI 2025	same	2025-04-23	Vendor survey. Fetched + grep-verified
19%	AI users in the "Frontier" zone (high individual and organisational readiness)	Microsoft WTI 2026	https://www.microsoft.com/en-us/worklab/work-trend-index/agents-human-agency-and-the-opportunity-for-every-organization	2026-05-05	n=20,000 AI users, 10 markets, self-report. Fetched
67% vs 32%	Share of modelled "AI impact" from organisational vs individual factors	Microsoft WTI 2026	same	2026-05-05	Random-forest importance on self-report; associational. Fetched
13%	AI users rewarded for reinventing work with AI even if results aren't met	Microsoft WTI 2026	same	2026-05-05	Self-report. Fetched
15x	Year-on-year growth in active agents in Microsoft 365	Microsoft WTI 2026	same	2026-05-05	Vendor telemetry, no absolute counts. Fetched
25% vs 14%	Frontier vs other professionals saying agent workflows/handoffs are documented at org level	Microsoft WTI 2026	same	2026-05-05	Self-report. Fetched

Figure	What it measures	Source	URL	Date	Reliability note
700	FTE customer service agents Klarna said its AI assistant replaced	Klarna via eMarketer	https://www.emarketer.com/content/klarna-backtracks-ai-customer-service-plans	2024-02 (claim)	Company claim; search summary only
~9,000 to ~5,000	Salesforce support headcount, per Benioff	Fortune	https://fortune.com/2025/09/02/salesforce-ceo-billionaire-marc-benioff-ai-agents-jobs-layoffs-customer-service-sales/	2025-09-02	CEO podcast remark; no timeframe; search summary only
"a couple of hundred"	IBM HR roles replaced by AI	Entrepreneur citing WSJ	https://www.entrepreneur.com/business-news/ibm-ceo-ai-replaced-hundreds-of-human-resources-staff/491341	2025-05	CEO statement; search summary only
$400,000 ($225k + $175k)	SEC civil penalties, Delphia and Global Predictions AI-washing settlements	SEC press release 2024-36	https://www.sec.gov/newsroom/press-releases/2024-36	2024-03-18	Regulatory action; search extract
>70%	Share of Presto Voice orders needing human intervention, per SEC case	SEC settlement via law-firm summaries	https://www.dandodiary.com/2025/01/articles/artificial-intelligence/sec-files-ai-washing-enforcement-action-against-restaurant-technology-company/	2025-01-14	Regulatory finding as reported; SEC primary not seen
$40M+ / ~0%	Raised by Nate on AI claims / alleged real automation rate	DOJ SDNY press release	https://www.justice.gov/usao-sdny/pr/tech-ceo-charged-artificial-intelligence-investment-fraud-scheme	2025-04-09	Allegations in an indictment, not findings
5	Companies in FTC Operation AI Comply	FTC press release	https://www.ftc.gov/news-events/news/press-releases/2024/09/ftc-announces-crackdown-deceptive-ai-claims-schemes	2024-09-25	Regulatory action; search extract
~130	Vendors with genuine agentic capability, of thousands claiming it	Gartner press release	https://www.gartner.com/en/newsroom/press-releases/2025-06-25-gartner-predicts-over-40-percent-of-agentic-ai-projects-will-be-canceled-by-end-of-2027	2025-06-25	Analyst estimate, no method
5,527 to 3,422	Klarna full-time employees, end-2022 to end-2024	Klarna F-1, via press	https://www.sec.gov/Archives/edgar/data/2003292/000162828025012824/klarnagroupplcf-1.htm	2025-03	Filing figure seen only in secondary reports
2.3M / two-thirds	Chats handled by Klarna's assistant in first month / share of all service chats	Klarna via Euronews	https://www.euronews.com/2024/02/28/klarnas-ai-bot-is-doing-the-work-of-700-employees-what-will-happen-to-their-jobs	2024-02-28	Company claim
~10%	Decline in Duolingo US daily active users linked to the AI-first memo	Morgan Stanley via iTiger	https://www.itiger.com/news/2549526150	2025	Sell-side analyst attribution
721	Firms in MIT CISR AI maturity survey (2022)	MIT CISR	https://cisr.mit.edu/sites/default/files/2024-12/EnterpriseAIMaturityModel_CISRpressrelease_121924_0.pdf	2024-12-19	Pre-genAI; search summary only

Verbatim quotes

- "The upshot is that deploying AI for complex tasks might be constrained more by access to information than on underlying model capabilities." (Anthropic Economic Index report, Anthropic, 15 Sep 2025) https://www.anthropic.com/research/anthropic-economic-index-september-2025-report. Context: the authors' reading of input-length data from 1M API transcripts. Verified: curl+grep
- "This could represent a barrier to broader enterprise deployment for some important tasks that rely on dispersed context that is not already centralized or digitized. Correcting for this bottleneck may require firms to restructure their organization, invest in new data infrastructure, and centralize information for effective model deployment." (Anthropic

Economic Index, 15 Sep 2025) same URL. Context: the closest primary statement to the user's shared-context definition. Verified: curl+grep

- "For software development with centralized code repositories, access to this information is in principle straightforward." (Anthropic Economic Index, 15 Sep 2025) same URL. Context: why coding leads agent adoption. Verified: curl+grep
- "I work way more with Claude than with any of my colleagues." (Anonymous Anthropic engineer, "How AI is transforming work at Anthropic", 2 Dec 2025) https://www.anthropic.com/research/how-ai-is-transforming-work-at-anthropic. Context: reduced collaboration. Verified: curl+grep
- "More junior people don't come to me with questions as often." (Anonymous senior Anthropic engineer, same source, 2 Dec 2025) same URL. Context: mentorship loss. Verified: curl+grep
- "Structured around on-demand intelligence and powered by "hybrid" teams of humans + agents, these companies scale rapidly, operate with agility, and generate value faster." (Microsoft, 2025 Work Trend Index, 23 Apr 2025) https://www.microsoft.com/en-us/worklab/work-trend-index/2025-the-year-the-frontier-firm-is-born. Context: the Frontier Firm definition. Verified: curl+grep (the page uses curly quotes around hybrid)
- "In many cases, people are ready. The systems around them are not." (Microsoft, 2026 Work Trend Index, 5 May 2026) https://www.microsoft.com/en-us/worklab/work-trend-index/agents-human-agency-and-the-opportunity-for-every-organization. Context: framing for the "Transformation Paradox". Verified: curl+grep
- "They capture these signals and encode them into shared routines, improving future work while preserving accountability and control." (Microsoft, 2026 Work Trend Index, 5 May 2026) same URL. Context: what Frontier Firms do with agent outputs; the nearest Microsoft gets to "shared context". Verified: curl+grep
- "Organizations that can answer these questions are building Owned Intelligence" (Microsoft, 2026 Work Trend Index, 5 May 2026) same URL. Context: the page then defines Owned Intelligence as institutional know-how unique to the firm. Verified: curl+grep

Sources worth reading in full (ranked, one line each on why)

1. Anthropic Economic Index, Sep 2025: the best large-sample evidence that context access, not model ability, limits enterprise agent deployment. https://www.anthropic.com/research/anthropic-economic-index-september-2025-report
2. Microsoft Work Trend Index 2026: the newest maturity framework; its "people ready, systems not" finding challenges the "people resist" thesis; includes data on how often agent workflows are documented. https://www.microsoft.com/en-us/worklab/work-trend-index/agents-human-agency-and-the-opportunity-for-every-organization
3. Anthropic, "How AI is transforming work at Anthropic": a rare inside view of an AI-native organisation, including its costs. https://www.anthropic.com/research/how-ai-is-transforming-work-at-anthropic
4. Ericsson, "Defining AI native": the only maturity model built around the word "native", and it admits the term is undefined. https://www.ericsson.com/en/reports-and-papers/white-papers/ai-native
5. Foundation Capital, "Context graphs": the VC thesis closest to the user's definition, to engage with or distinguish from. https://foundationcapital.com/context-graphs-ais-trillion-dollar-opportunity/

6. MIT CISR Enterprise AI Maturity Model: the only maturity model I found that links stages to financial performance; pre-genAI. https://cisr.mit.edu/publication/2024_1201_EnterpriseAIMaturityModel_WeillWoernerSebastian
7. Microsoft Work Trend Index 2025: origin of the "Frontier Firm" and "human-agent ratio" language that now circulates. https://www.microsoft.com/en-us/worklab/work-trend-index/2025-the-year-the-frontier-firm-is-born
8. Nokia Bell Labs, "Toward a 6G AI-Native Air Interface": the earliest formal use of the term I found. https://arxiv.org/pdf/2012.08285
9. DOJ SDNY release on Nate/Saniger: the starkest documented case of "AI" that was humans, useful for any piece on AI-washing. https://www.justice.gov/usao-sdny/pr/tech-ceo-charged-artificial-intelligence-investment-fraud-scheme
10. SEC press release 2024-36 (Delphia and Global Predictions): the first SEC AI-washing cases and the template for later ones. https://www.sec.gov/newsroom/press-releases/2024-36
11. FTC Operation AI Comply release: shows consumer-protection law applied to AI capability claims. https://www.ftc.gov/news-events/news/press-releases/2024/09/ftc-announces-crackdown-deceptive-ai-claims-schemes